

# Tests and studying

There are many different types of tests, but all are designed to review a teen's knowledge and understanding of a subject under timed conditions. While every teen is different, having a study schedule and plenty of time to prepare can help build confidence.

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## Studying for a test

Tests can be challenging, especially when several are scheduled to take place in a short period of time. Effective studying starts months in advance of a test, when students first start to learn about and take notes on a subject.

### ▽ Keep things varied

How a teen studies is as important as how much time they spend studying. There are a variety of methods teens can try.

## TEEN HINTS

### Study environment

Where you study can affect how well you study. Choose a quiet, well-lit place that's free from distractions. Make sure your chair is comfortable. If possible, try not to work in your bedroom, so that you associate your room with relaxing.

## Reading notes

When studying, reading over class notes helps teens to improve their understanding and identify areas for further study. Writing notes out using different colors, reducing them down to key points, drawing mind-maps, and annotating hand-outs are all great ways to make the most of class notes.



## Memorizing

People have different ways of committing information to memory. Some students organize their notes using a color-coding system to pick out themes or topics. Some visualize the information on the page or associate ideas with pictures or diagrams. Others record themselves or somebody else reading the notes out loud to listen to. Others still create mind-maps or diagrams to make the connections between things clear.



## Drafting model answers

Using past test papers, if it's possible to get them, is a useful way of recreating testlike conditions. It's also a chance to practice the style of the test, as well as to time how long each question will take to answer. Students can check their own answers against sample answers, and even ask their teacher to look at their work and provide feedback.

